resource constraints and the ability to balance personal commitments lingered. But I kept them to myself.

Ten days later, I participated in a hybrid meeting (both virtual and physical) convened by SBF, which afforded me insights into the Yatra's preparations. I met many eminent civil society activists, including Nikhil Dey, Amitabh Behar and Yogendra Yadav, who had gathered to offer suggestions on how civil society could be invited. Our deliberations included the planning for how to invite and involve civil society without making them lose their individual identities, arranging provisions for their accommodation and travel, emergency contingencies and the issuance of passes to facilitate entry into the camps where the yatris were supposed to get their meals. Given the complexities associated with coordinating with diverse groups (including Congress-party leaders and civil society organizations, many of whom had previously been against the Congress party), it was decided that two distinct teams would be formed. The first team, designated the 'Mobile Secretariat', comprised SBF's team, including Dr Nagorao Zapate, Kavita Sharma, Atif Raza and Armaan Lilothia, who were to coordinate with civil society across India and provide support from the Delhi office. The second team, designated the 'Coordination Team', was entrusted to me and was to be supported by Sunil Kumar, Dilip Jha and Lalu Kanojia (all idealistic university-going students), who had already left for Kanyakumari for assistance. Gurdeep Singh Sappal and SBF's director Pushparaj Deshpande assumed collective responsibility for streamlined coordination between both the teams.

The joint responsibilities of the two teams involved accompanying civil society participants in the Yatra, identifying and addressing their needs, facilitating their sustenance, ensuring respectful entry to resting/food places and creating requisite documentation (whether passes or lists) for interactions with Rahul Gandhi, Digvijaya Singh, Jairam Ramesh and other senior leaders in the Yatra. These tasks were compounded because security personnel deputed by each state police department was changing every 8 to 10 kilometres. This meant we had to deal with fresh people who didn't understand what civil society was and why they needed to be allowed in the